Remarks at the Brandenburg Gate (“Tear Down This Wall”)

President Ronald Reagan · June 12, 1987

Source: Ronald Reagan, Brandenburg Gate Address (1987). Public domain. Continuous passage.

> Standing before the Berlin Wall, Reagan challenged Soviet leader Mikhail Gorbachev to “tear down this wall,” framing the Cold War as a contest between freedom and tyranny — two years before the wall fell.

After these four decades, then, there stands before the entire world one great and inescapable conclusion: Freedom leads to prosperity. Freedom replaces the ancient hatreds among the nations with comity and peace. Freedom is the victor.

[. . .]

General Secretary Gorbachev, if you seek peace, if you seek prosperity for the Soviet Union and Eastern Europe, if you seek liberalization: Come here to this gate! Mr. Gorbachev, open this gate! Mr. Gorbachev, tear down this wall!